PART 1: TERMS OF SERVICE

Effective Date: October 24, 2026

These Terms of Service (the "Terms") are a binding agreement between you and Samuel Weimer, doing business as DevsConnect, operating as "devs-connect" ("devs-connect," "we," "us," or "our"), governing your access to and use of devs-connect.com and all related websites, applications, APIs, features, and services (collectively, the "Service").

PLEASE READ THESE TERMS CAREFULLY. THEY CONTAIN A BINDING CLASS ACTION AND JURY TRIAL WAIVER (SECTION 19), A DISCLAIMER OF WARRANTIES (SECTION 16), AND A LIMITATION OF LIABILITY (SECTION 17) THAT AFFECT YOUR LEGAL RIGHTS.

1. Acceptance of Terms

By creating an account, signing in (including through GitHub), or otherwise accessing or using the Service, you agree to be bound by these Terms, our Privacy Policy, and our Acceptable Use & Project Collaboration Guidelines (the "Guidelines"), each of which is incorporated by reference. If you do not agree, do not use the Service. If you use the Service on behalf of an organization, you represent that you have authority to bind that organization, and "you" includes that organization.

2. Independent Platform; No Affiliation; Third-Party Marks

2.1 Independence. devs-connect is an independent company. The Service, including its name, branding, logos, visual design, user interface, trade dress, features, and source code, was independently conceived, designed, and developed by or for devs-connect.

2.2 No affiliation. devs-connect is not affiliated with, associated with, sponsored by, authorized by, endorsed by, or in any way officially connected to LinkedIn Corporation, Microsoft Corporation (including GitHub, Inc. and Xbox), Reddit, Inc., or any of their respective parents, subsidiaries, or affiliates, nor to any other third-party platform referenced on the Service.

2.3 Third-party marks. LinkedIn, Microsoft, GitHub, Xbox, Reddit, and all other third-party names, logos, and marks are the property of their respective owners. devs-connect claims no ownership of any third-party mark. Any reference to a third-party product, platform, or service is made solely to identify it or to describe the Service's functionality or interoperability (for example, signing in with GitHub or linking a repository), is nominative and descriptive, and does not imply any sponsorship, endorsement, or affiliation.

2.4 Your references. You agree not to state or imply that devs-connect is affiliated with or endorsed by any third party, and not to use our name or marks in a way that suggests such a relationship.

3. Eligibility and Accounts

3.1 Eligibility. You must be at least 18 years old and capable of forming a binding contract. You may not use the Service if you are barred from doing so under applicable law or if we previously terminated your account for cause.

3.2 Registration. You must provide accurate, current, and complete information and keep it updated. You may not impersonate any person or misrepresent your skills, employment history, certifications, or affiliations.

3.3 Security. You are responsible for all activity under your account and for maintaining the security of your credentials, sessions, and connected accounts. Notify us promptly of any unauthorized use. We are not liable for losses caused by unauthorized use of your account.

3.4 One account. You may maintain only one personal account unless we permit otherwise in writing.

3.5 Adults only; unauthorized access by minors. The Service is intended solely for adults. Anyone under 18 is prohibited from creating an account or using the Service, and any such access is unauthorized and a violation of these Terms. By creating an account, you represent and warrant that you are at least 18 years old. We do not knowingly permit minors to use the Service, and we will terminate accounts and delete data that we learn belong to anyone under 18. Any person under 18 who accesses the Service in violation of these Terms, and any person who sends or shows content to a minor in violation of these Terms or applicable law, is solely responsible for that conduct and its consequences. To the fullest extent permitted by law, devs-connect is not responsible or liable for it. Please report suspected under-18 accounts to support@devs-connect.com.

4. Third-Party Services and GitHub Integration

4.1 Authentication. The Service uses third-party authentication and identity providers, including GitHub OAuth, Stytch, and Firebase Authentication. By connecting a third-party account, you authorize us to access and process the data permitted by the scopes you approve, including your public GitHub profile and public repository information, and to synchronize it with your devs-connect profile.

4.2 Third-party terms. Your use of third-party services is governed by their own terms and privacy policies. We do not control and are not responsible for third-party services, their availability, their changes, or their handling of your data. A third party may revoke or change API access at any time, which may degrade or disable related features.

4.3 Revoking access. You may revoke our access through your third-party account settings. Revocation may limit your ability to use certain features.

4.4 Linked repositories. Linking a repository does not transfer ownership or grant us rights in the repository's source code beyond the license in Section 5 for the content you choose to display on the Service, and does not alter the license under which the repository is published.

5. Your Content and License to Us

5.1 Your content. "User Content" means anything you submit, post, upload, transmit, or make available through the Service, including profiles, career histories, skills, certifications, portfolios, posts, comments, project descriptions, code snippets, links, images, avatars, banners, attachments, and messages. **As between you and devs-connect, you retain ownership of your User Content** and of your proprietary code and projects.

5.2 License grant. You grant devs-connect a worldwide, non-exclusive, royalty-free, fully paid-up, perpetual, transferable, and sublicensable (through multiple tiers) license to host, store, reproduce, cache, index, format, adapt, translate, modify (for technical purposes such as formatting and thumbnails), publish, publicly display, publicly perform, distribute, and otherwise use your User Content in connection with operating, securing, improving, promoting, and commercializing the Service and our business, in any media now known or later developed. This includes the right to use User Content that is public on the Service to generate search results, recommendations, previews, and promotional excerpts.

5.3 Deletion. If you delete User Content or close your account, we will remove it from public view within a reasonable time. The license continues for (a) copies retained in backups and archives for a limited period, (b) content others have shared, quoted, replied to, or incorporated (such as comments on threads), (c) aggregated or de-identified data derived from your content, and (d) as needed to comply with law, resolve disputes, and enforce our agreements.

5.4 Private content and messages. Content you mark private and direct messages are not publicly displayed, and we will use them only to operate, secure, and support the Service, to comply with law, and as described in the Privacy Policy.

5.5 Your representations. You represent and warrant that you own or have all necessary rights, licenses, and permissions to submit your User Content and grant the license above; that your User Content and our use of it as permitted here will not infringe, misappropriate, or violate any third party's rights (including copyrights, open-source license obligations, trade secrets, confidentiality or employer obligations) or any law; and that you are not disclosing confidential information of any employer or client.

5.6 Feedback. If you give us ideas, suggestions, or feedback, you grant us a perpetual, irrevocable, worldwide, royalty-free license to use it without restriction or compensation.

5.7 Employer and client restrictions. You are solely responsible for ensuring that sharing code, project details, or career information does not breach your employment agreement, invention-assignment agreement, NDA, or any client contract.

6. Code, Libraries, and Technical Content

6.1 As-is code. Any code, snippets, libraries, packages, configuration, architectural advice, or technical suggestions posted by users or linked from the Service ("Shared Code") is provided by the posting user, **not by devs-connect**, and is provided **"AS IS" without warranty of any kind.** devs-connect does not review, test, verify, or endorse Shared Code.

6.2 Your risk. You use Shared Code entirely at your own risk. You are solely responsible for reviewing it for security vulnerabilities, malware, bugs, and fitness for your purpose, and for determining and complying with any applicable license (including MIT, Apache 2.0, BSD, GPL, AGPL, or proprietary terms). Shared Code may carry license obligations that conflict with your intended use.

6.3 Disclaimer. To the fullest extent permitted by law, devs-connect disclaims all liability for copyright or patent infringement, license conflicts or violations, malware, security incidents, data loss, defects, downtime, or commercial loss arising from Shared Code or its use.

6.4 Posting code. If you post code you do not own, you must identify its source and license and have the right to share it. Do not post code or credentials that are confidential, that include secrets (API keys, tokens, passwords), or that you are not permitted to disclose.

7. Project Matchmaking and Collaboration

7.1 Passive venue. The Service provides a venue for developers to discover one another and post or find projects, teams, and collaborators (including "looking for group" and co-founder listings). **devs-connect is a passive venue only.** We are not a party to any agreement, relationship, partnership, joint venture, employment, contractor, or equity arrangement between users, and we are not an employer, staffing agency, broker, escrow, or agent of any user.

7.2 No vetting. We do not verify the identity, skills, credentials, background, intentions, financial standing, or trustworthiness of any user, nor the accuracy, legality, or viability of any project, listing, or profile. A profile badge, connected GitHub account, or "verified" label (if any) is not a guarantee.

7.3 No responsibility for collaborations. To the fullest extent permitted by law, devs-connect disclaims all responsibility and liability for: (a) disputes among users or collaborators, including disputes over equity, ownership, revenue share, authorship, or intellectual property in any project; (b) co-founder disagreements or dissolution of teams; (c) unpaid work, non-payment, scope disputes, or misclassification; (d) breach of any NDA, confidentiality, non-compete, or other agreement between users; (e) project abandonment, missed deadlines, or failure; (f) the conduct, statements, or work product of any user; and (g) losses from reliance on any listing or profile.

7.4 Your responsibility. Before collaborating, you are responsible for performing your own due diligence and for documenting your arrangement in a written agreement that addresses ownership, IP assignment or licensing, equity, compensation, confidentiality, and exit. **We strongly recommend consulting a qualified attorney before entering any co-founder, equity, or IP-sharing arrangement.** Nothing on the Service is legal, tax, financial, or business advice.

7.5 Confidential ideas. Do not post information you consider a trade secret or confidential. Public listings are visible to others, and devs-connect has no obligation to keep any public or shared idea confidential. devs-connect is not a party to and does not enforce NDAs between users.

7.6 Meeting in person. If you meet other users offline, you do so at your own risk. Use reasonable caution.

8. Communities, Messaging, and Moderation

8.1 Communities. Communities may have additional rules set by their moderators. Community moderators are users, not devs-connect employees or agents, and we are not responsible for their actions or inaction.

8.2 Messaging. Messages are delivered over real-time connections that may be interrupted. We do not guarantee delivery, ordering, retention, or confidentiality of any message beyond what the Privacy Policy states, and we may review messages as described in the Privacy Policy where necessary for safety, abuse prevention, legal compliance, or enforcement.

8.3 Moderation discretion. We may, but have no obligation to, monitor, review, edit, remove, restrict, or refuse any User Content or account, for any reason or no reason, including to enforce these Terms. We are not liable for failing to remove content or for removing content. Blocking, visibility settings, and reporting tools are aids and do not guarantee protection from unwanted contact or exposure.

8.4 No endorsement. We do not endorse User Content and are not responsible for it. Opinions expressed by users are theirs alone.

9. Paid Features, Subscriptions, and Billing

9.1 Current and future paid offerings. We may now or in the future offer paid features, including premium memberships, enhanced matchmaking or visibility tiers, recruiter or team seats, sponsored placements, and other paid products ("Paid Services"), each subject to the pricing and terms presented at purchase, which are incorporated into these Terms.

9.2 Billing. By purchasing, you authorize us and our payment processors to charge your payment method for all fees and applicable taxes. **Unless stated otherwise at purchase, subscriptions renew automatically** for successive periods equal to the initial term until cancelled. You can cancel in your account settings before the renewal date to avoid the next charge.

9.3 Fees non-refundable. To the fullest extent permitted by law, all fees are non-refundable, and we do not provide refunds or credits for partial periods, unused features, downgrade, or termination, except where required by law or expressly stated by us.

9.4 Changes. We may change pricing, plans, features, and the allocation of features among free and paid tiers at any time. For a change to the price of an active subscription, we will give you reasonable advance notice (for example, by email or in-app notice), and the change will apply at your next renewal. Your continued use after the effective date constitutes acceptance, and you may cancel before the change takes effect.

9.5 Free features. Free features are provided without any commitment of continued availability, and we may limit, modify, or discontinue them at any time.

9.6 Taxes and chargebacks. You are responsible for all taxes. Initiating a chargeback in bad faith may result in suspension, and you agree to reimburse our reasonable costs of resolving it.

9.7 Payment processors. Payments are handled by third-party processors, and we do not store full payment card numbers. Your use of a processor is subject to its terms.

10. Advertising, Sponsorships, and Platform Data

10.1 Ads and sponsorships. We may display advertising, sponsored posts, sponsored communities, promoted listings, affiliate links, and other commercial content on the Service, and may use contextual, interest-based, or targeted advertising, subject to applicable law and our Privacy Policy. We may include third-party technologies such as cookies, pixels, SDKs, and similar tools. We are not responsible for advertisers' content or products, and your dealings with advertisers are solely between you and them. Sponsored content will be labeled where required by law.

10.2 Aggregated and de-identified data. We may collect, compile, analyze, and use usage data and User Content in aggregated, de-identified, or anonymized form (information that does not reasonably identify you), and may use, publish, license, sell, and otherwise commercialize that data (for example, developer trend data, industry statistics, skills and hiring analytics, and platform insights) to third parties, without compensation to you. We own all rights in such aggregated or de-identified data.

10.3 Personal information. How we collect, use, disclose, and (where applicable) sell or share personal information is governed by the Privacy Policy.

10.4 Business model evolution. The Service is under active development. We may change, add, or remove features and business models, including those described above, at any time, subject to the notice and other requirements in these Terms and applicable law.

11. Our Intellectual Property

The Service, including its software, source code, design, layout, interface, text, graphics, logos, compilations, and trade dress (excluding User Content), is owned by devs-connect or its licensors and protected by intellectual property laws. Subject to these Terms, we grant you a limited, revocable, non-exclusive, non-transferable, non-sublicensable license to access and use the Service for your personal or internal business purposes. You may not copy, scrape, reverse engineer, decompile, resell, or create derivative works of the Service, or use it to build a competing product, except as permitted by law or by written agreement. All rights not expressly granted are reserved.

12. Copyright Policy and DMCA Notices

12.1 We respect intellectual property rights and respond to notices of alleged infringement that comply with the Digital Millennium Copyright Act (17 U.S.C. § 512). We may remove or disable access to allegedly infringing material and may notify the user who posted it.

12.2 Designated agent. Send notices of claimed infringement to our designated copyright agent: Samuel Weimer, 2272 Lupine Lane, Christiansburg, VA 24073, US, Email: support@devs-connect.com.

12.3 Contents of a takedown notice. A valid notice must be in writing and include: (a) the physical or electronic signature of the copyright owner or authorized agent; (b) identification of the copyrighted work claimed to be infringed; (c) identification of the allegedly infringing material and information reasonably sufficient for us to locate it (such as URLs); (d) your contact information; (e) a statement that you have a good-faith belief that the use is not authorized by the copyright owner, its agent, or the law; and (f) a statement, under penalty of perjury, that the information is accurate and that you are authorized to act for the copyright owner. **Knowingly misrepresenting that material is infringing may make you liable for damages, including costs and attorneys' fees (17 U.S.C. § 512(f)).**

12.4 Counter-notice. If you believe material you posted was removed by mistake or misidentification, you may send a counter-notice to the agent above containing: (a) your physical or electronic signature; (b) identification of the removed material and its prior location; (c) a statement under penalty of perjury that you have a good-faith belief the material was removed by mistake or misidentification; and (d) your name, address, and phone number, a statement that you consent to the jurisdiction of the federal court for the district where you are located (or, if outside the U.S., any district where devs-connect may be found), and that you will accept service of process from the person who submitted the original notice.

We may restore the material in 10 to 14 business days after receiving a valid counter-notice unless the complainant notifies us that it has filed a court action.

12.5 Repeat infringers. In appropriate circumstances, we will terminate the accounts of users who are repeat infringers, and we may terminate after a single infringement where warranted.

12.6 Other IP complaints. For trademark or other non-copyright complaints, email support@devs-connect.com with details, and we will review them in our discretion.

13. Acceptable Use

You agree to comply with the Guidelines (Part 3) and applicable law. You will not use the Service to violate others' rights, post unlawful, harassing, deceptive, or infringing content, distribute malware, scrape or overload the Service, circumvent security or access controls, or use automated means to access the Service without our written permission. We may investigate violations and cooperate with law enforcement and rights holders.

14. Suspension and Termination

14.1 By you. You may stop using the Service and delete your account at any time through settings or by contacting us.

14.2 By us. We may suspend, restrict, or terminate your account or access to any part of the Service **at any time, at our sole discretion, with or without notice, and with or without cause or explanation,** including for violation of these Terms or the Guidelines, legal or safety concerns, extended inactivity, or discontinuation of the Service. Where a particular law requires notice or a reason, we will provide it to the extent required.

14.3 Effect. Upon termination, your right to use the Service ends, and we may delete your content and data subject to the Privacy Policy and legal retention requirements. Sections that by their nature should survive will survive, including Sections 2, 5 through 7, 9 (as to accrued fees), 10.2, 11, 12, 14.3, and 16 through 23.

14.4 No liability. We are not liable to you or any third party for any suspension, termination, or removal of content.

15. Service Changes and Availability

We may modify, suspend, or discontinue the Service or any feature at any time. We do not guarantee any specific uptime, performance, or availability, and the Service may be unavailable due to maintenance, technical failures, third-party outages, or events beyond our control.

16. DISCLAIMER OF WARRANTIES

THE SERVICE AND ALL CONTENT, CODE, AND MATERIALS MADE AVAILABLE THROUGH IT ARE PROVIDED "AS IS" AND "AS AVAILABLE," WITHOUT WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, WHETHER EXPRESS, IMPLIED, OR STATUTORY. TO THE FULLEST EXTENT PERMITTED BY LAW, DEVS-CONNECT DISCLAIMS ALL WARRANTIES, INCLUDING IMPLIED WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY, FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE, TITLE, ACCURACY, AND NON-INFRINGEMENT. WE DO NOT WARRANT THAT THE SERVICE

WILL BE UNINTERRUPTED, TIMELY, SECURE, OR ERROR-FREE; THAT MESSAGES OR NOTIFICATIONS WILL BE DELIVERED OR RECEIVED; THAT DATA WILL NOT BE LOST OR CORRUPTED; THAT ANY USER, PROFILE, OR LISTING IS ACCURATE OR TRUSTWORTHY; OR THAT ANY COLLABORATION OR OPPORTUNITY WILL RESULT FROM USE OF THE SERVICE. Some jurisdictions do not allow certain disclaimers, so some of the above may not apply to you.

17. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

TO THE FULLEST EXTENT PERMITTED BY LAW: (A) DEVS-CONNECT AND ITS AFFILIATES, OFFICERS, DIRECTORS, EMPLOYEES, CONTRACTORS, AGENTS, LICENSORS, AND SUCCESSORS WILL NOT BE LIABLE FOR ANY INDIRECT, INCIDENTAL, SPECIAL, CONSEQUENTIAL, EXEMPLARY, OR PUNITIVE DAMAGES, OR FOR ANY LOSS OF PROFITS, REVENUE, DATA, GOODWILL, BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY, OR EQUITY, ARISING OUT OF OR RELATING TO THE SERVICE OR THESE TERMS, EVEN IF ADVISED OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGES; AND (B) OUR TOTAL AGGREGATE LIABILITY FOR ALL CLAIMS RELATING TO THE SERVICE OR THESE TERMS WILL NOT EXCEED THE LESSER OF (I) THE AMOUNT YOU PAID TO DEVS-CONNECT IN THE 12 MONTHS BEFORE THE EVENT GIVING RISE TO THE CLAIM, OR (II) FIFTY U.S. DOLLARS (US $50). These limitations apply regardless of the legal theory (contract, tort, negligence, strict liability, or otherwise). Some jurisdictions do not allow certain limitations, so some may not apply to you. Nothing in these Terms excludes liability that cannot be excluded under applicable law.

18. Indemnification

You agree to defend, indemnify, and hold harmless devs-connect and its affiliates, officers, directors, employees, contractors, agents, successors, and assigns from and against any claims, liabilities, damages, losses, and expenses (including reasonable attorneys' fees) arising out of or related to: (a) your User Content; (b) your use or misuse of the Service; (c) your violation of these Terms, the Guidelines, or applicable law; (d) your violation of any third party's rights, including intellectual property, confidentiality, or employer rights; or (e) any dispute between you and another user. We may assume exclusive control of the defense of any matter, and you agree to cooperate.

19. Dispute Resolution; Class Action and Jury Trial Waiver

PLEASE READ THIS SECTION CAREFULLY. IT AFFECTS YOUR RIGHT TO PARTICIPATE IN A CLASS ACTION OR JURY TRIAL.

19.1 Informal resolution first. Before filing a claim, you agree to contact us at support@devs-connect.com with a written description of the dispute and your requested relief and to try in good faith to resolve it for 30 days.

19.2 Courts. Subject to Section 20, any dispute, claim, or controversy arising out of or relating to these Terms or the Service will be brought in the state or federal courts located in Montgomery County, Virginia, and you and we consent to the jurisdiction of those courts. Either party may bring an individual claim in small-claims court if it qualifies.

19.3 CLASS ACTION AND JURY TRIAL WAIVER. TO THE FULLEST EXTENT PERMITTED BY LAW, YOU AND WE EACH WAIVE THE RIGHT TO A JURY TRIAL AND THE RIGHT TO BRING OR PARTICIPATE IN ANY CLASS, COLLECTIVE, CONSOLIDATED, OR REPRESENTATIVE ACTION OR PROCEEDING. CLAIMS MAY BE

BROUGHT ONLY IN AN INDIVIDUAL CAPACITY. If this waiver is found unenforceable as to a claim, that waiver is severed as to that claim only, and the rest of these Terms remain in effect.

19.4 Limitations period. To the extent permitted by law, any claim must be filed within one (1) year after it arose, or it is permanently barred.

19.5 Survival. This Section survives termination of the Terms and your account.

20. Governing Law and Venue

These Terms and any dispute are governed by the laws of the State of Virginia, without regard to conflict-of-law rules. For any dispute, you agree to the exclusive jurisdiction and venue of the state and federal courts located in Montgomery County, Virginia, and waive any objection to those courts. If you are a consumer in the EU, UK, or another jurisdiction whose mandatory consumer laws provide otherwise, you retain the protections those laws guarantee.

21. Changes to These Terms

We may update these Terms from time to time. For material changes, we will provide notice by email, in-app notice, or a prominent posting on the Service, with a new effective date, generally at least 14 days before the change takes effect (sooner where required by law or for legal, security, or emergency reasons). **By continuing to use the Service after the effective date, you accept the updated Terms.** If you do not agree, you must stop using the Service and may close your account. Changes do not apply to disputes already pending.

22. Assignment, Mergers, and Corporate Transactions

You may not assign or transfer these Terms or your account without our consent. **devs-connect may freely assign, transfer, delegate, or sublicense these Terms and any of its rights and obligations, in whole or in part, without notice to or consent from you, including in connection with a merger, acquisition, financing, reorganization, change of control, sale of all or part of our assets or business, bankruptcy, or similar transaction.** In any such transaction, your account, User Content, and the data we hold about you (including personal information) may be transferred to and used by the successor, which will be bound by the commitments in the Privacy Policy then in effect with respect to your data until it provides you notice of changes as required by law.

23. General

Entire agreement. These Terms, the Privacy Policy, the Guidelines, and any additional terms you accept are the entire agreement between you and us on this subject. **Severability.** If any provision is unenforceable, it will be enforced to the maximum extent permissible and the rest remains in effect. **No waiver.** Our failure to enforce a provision is not a waiver. **No third-party beneficiaries.** Except for our affiliates and successors as stated, there are none. **Electronic communications.** You consent to receive notices electronically. **Force majeure.** We are not liable for delay or failure caused by events beyond our reasonable control. **Export and sanctions.** You may not use the Service if you are subject to U.S. sanctions or located in an embargoed jurisdiction. **Headings** are for convenience only. **Notices to us:**

Samuel Weimer, doing business as DevsConnect, 2272 Lupine Lane, Christiansburg, VA 24073, US, support@devs-connect.com.

PART 2: PRIVACY POLICY

Effective Date: October 24, 2026

This Privacy Policy explains how Samuel Weimer, doing business as DevsConnect ("devs-connect," "we," "us," or "our") collects, uses, shares, and protects personal information when you use devs-connect.com and our related services (the "Service"). By using the Service, you acknowledge this Policy. Capitalized terms not defined here have the meanings in our Terms of Service.

devs-connect is an independent company and is not affiliated with LinkedIn, Microsoft, GitHub, Reddit, or any of their affiliates. We receive data from GitHub only when you choose to connect your GitHub account.

1. Information We Collect

1.1 Information you provide. Account and profile details (name, username, email, photo, banner, bio, location, links); career history, skills, certifications, and portfolio items; posts, comments, project listings, community memberships, and saved posts; connections, friend requests, and blocks; direct messages and attachments; support requests, feedback, and reports; and billing information if you purchase Paid Services (processed by our payment provider).

1.2 Information from connected accounts. If you sign in with or link GitHub, we receive information permitted by the scopes you approve, which may include your GitHub username, ID, public profile details, email address, and public repository information (such as repository names, descriptions, languages, stars, and public activity). If you use Stytch or Firebase Authentication, those providers return identifiers and authentication data to us. We do not receive your GitHub password.

1.3 Information collected automatically. IP address, device and browser type and version, operating system, referring pages, pages and features used, timestamps, session identifiers, authentication tokens, cookies and similar technologies, error and performance logs, and approximate location inferred from IP address.

1.4 Information from others. Information other users provide about you (for example, messages, mentions, or reports) and information from service providers and, where permitted, public sources.

1.5 Sensitive information. We do not intend to collect sensitive categories of personal information (such as health, race, religion, or government ID numbers). Please do not post them. If you do, you consent to our processing of them as part of your public or shared content.

2. How We Use Information and Our Legal Bases

We use personal information to:

- **Provide and operate the Service** (create and manage accounts, display profiles, enable communities, messaging, and project matchmaking, sync GitHub data). *Legal basis (GDPR): performance of a contract.*
- **Secure the Service and prevent abuse** (authentication, fraud and spam detection, enforcing Terms, safety, moderation, debugging). *Legitimate interests; legal obligation.*
- **Improve and develop the Service** (analytics, research, testing, building new features and products, training and tuning recommendation and matching features). *Legitimate interests.*
- **Personalize** (recommendations, suggested connections, communities, and projects). *Legitimate interests; contract.*
- **Communicate** (service notices, security alerts, updates, support, and, with consent where required, marketing). *Contract; legitimate interests; consent.*
- **Process payments and manage subscriptions.** *Contract; legal obligation.*
- **Advertising and sponsorships**, including measuring and, where enabled, showing contextual or interest-based ads. *Legitimate interests or consent, as required by law.*
- **Create aggregated or de-identified data** and use it for analytics, industry insights, and commercial purposes (see Section 4).
- **Comply with law**, respond to legal process, and protect rights, property, and safety. *Legal obligation; legitimate interests.*

Where we rely on consent, you may withdraw it at any time, without affecting prior processing.

3. Public Information and Visibility

Much of what you add to your profile, communities, and project listings is public by default unless you set it to private using available visibility controls (including hiding GitHub activity or specific profile sections). Public information can be seen by anyone, indexed by search engines, copied, and used by others, and we cannot control that use. Direct messages are intended for their recipients, but recipients can copy or share them. Think carefully before posting personal or confidential information.

4. How We Share Information

We do not sell your personal information for money as of the effective date. We share personal information as follows:

- **Other users and the public**, as you direct through your settings and content.
- **Service providers and processors** that help us run the Service and are bound by confidentiality and data-protection obligations, including: Amazon Web Services (storage and hosting, including S3 for uploaded files); GitHub (OAuth sign-in and repository data); Stytch and Google Firebase (authentication); Redis (session management and caching); email delivery, analytics, error-monitoring, and payment processing providers (we will update this list as we adopt specific providers); and professional advisers such as lawyers, auditors, and insurers.
- **Advertising and analytics partners**, if and when we enable ads or tracking technologies, subject to the choices described in Sections 9 and 10.
- **Aggregated and de-identified data.** We may share, license, or sell aggregated, de-identified, or anonymized information (including developer trend data, skills statistics, industry insights, and

platform analytics) that does not reasonably identify you. We will not attempt to re-identify it and will contractually require recipients not to attempt re-identification where required by law.

- **Business transfers.** If we are involved in a merger, acquisition, financing, reorganization, bankruptcy, receivership, sale of assets, or change of control, or are evaluating one, your information (including personal information and account data) may be disclosed to or transferred to a successor, acquirer, or other party to the transaction. The successor may use your information as described in this Policy and will give you notice of any material changes in use as required by law.
- **Legal and safety.** To comply with law, regulation, subpoena, court order, or government request, to enforce our Terms, to protect the rights, property, or safety of users, us, or the public, and to detect or prevent fraud or security issues.
- **With your consent or at your direction.**

Future changes. If we begin selling or sharing personal information (as those terms are defined by applicable privacy laws) or using it in materially new ways, we will update this Policy, provide notice, and offer any opt-out or consent options the law requires before doing so.

5. Cookies, Tracking, and Analytics

We use cookies, local storage, pixels, and similar technologies to keep you signed in, maintain sessions, remember preferences, secure the Service, measure performance, and understand usage. Types include strictly necessary, preference, analytics, and (if enabled) advertising cookies. Where required (for example, in the EU/UK), we will ask for consent to non-essential cookies, and you can change your choices in your browser settings. We honor Global Privacy Control signals and legally recognized opt-out preference signals where required. Because browsers differ, “Do Not Track” signals are not currently recognized.

6. Telemetry and Logs

We log technical and usage data, including IP addresses, browser user agents, device information, timestamps, and feature interactions, for system integrity, security, abuse prevention, debugging, analytics, and product development. Logs are retained for the periods described in Section 8.

7. Direct Messages and Real-Time Chat

Messages are transmitted using real-time connections (such as WebSockets) and stored on our systems so that you can see conversation history. Messages are protected by transport encryption in transit and access controls; unless we state otherwise in the product, they are not end-to-end encrypted, meaning authorized personnel and systems may access them where necessary to operate the Service, investigate abuse or reports, respond to legal process, protect safety, and enforce our Terms. We do not use the content of private messages for third-party advertising.

8. Data Retention

We keep personal information for as long as your account is active and as needed to provide the Service, comply with legal obligations, resolve disputes, enforce agreements, and for legitimate business purposes. In general: account and profile data is retained while your account is active and until you ask

us to delete it. When we receive a verified deletion request, we permanently delete or de-identify your information and email you to confirm once it is done, generally within 45 days, with residual copies remaining in backups for up to 90 days; server and security logs are retained for up to 12 months; billing and tax records are retained as required by law; and information that others have copied, quoted, or replied to, or that has been aggregated or de-identified, may remain.

9. Your Choices and Rights

You can access, update, and delete much of your information in your account settings, set visibility controls, manage connected accounts, unsubscribe from marketing emails, and manage cookies. Depending on where you live, you may also have the rights below. To exercise them, email support@devs-connect.com. We will verify your identity and respond within the period required by law (generally 30 to 45 days).

9.1 All users. Access, correction, and deletion of your information, subject to legal exceptions, and closing your account.

9.2 EEA, UK, and Switzerland (GDPR). Rights to access, rectify, erase, restrict or object to processing, data portability, and withdraw consent, and to lodge a complaint with your local data protection authority. Where we process data based on legitimate interests, you may object, including to direct marketing at any time. We do not make decisions with legal or similarly significant effects based solely on automated processing.

9.3 California and other U.S. states (CCPA/CPRA and similar laws in states such as Virginia, Colorado, Connecticut, Utah, Texas, and others). Depending on your state, you may have the right to know/access and obtain a portable copy of your personal information, correct inaccuracies, delete your information, opt out of the sale or sharing of personal information and of targeted advertising and profiling, and limit use of sensitive personal information (we do not use sensitive personal information to infer characteristics about you). You will not be discriminated against for exercising these rights. You may appeal a denial by replying to our response. You may designate an authorized agent to make requests on your behalf, and we may require verification. **In the preceding 12 months, we have not sold personal information for monetary consideration and have not shared personal information for cross-context behavioral advertising.** If that changes, we will update this Policy and provide a “Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information” link and honor opt-out signals. Categories of personal information we collect (identifiers, internet activity, professional or employment information, user-generated content, and inferences used for personalization) and the purposes for which we use them are described in Sections 1 and 2; disclosures are described in Section 4. We retain information as described in Section 8.

9.4 California Shine the Light. California residents may request information about disclosures to third parties for their direct marketing purposes by emailing support@devs-connect.com.

10. Advertising

We do not currently serve third-party targeted advertising. If we introduce advertising, sponsored content, or tracking pixels, we will update this Policy and our cookie banner, provide the choices required by law, and label sponsored content. Contextual ads do not require cross-site tracking. Interest-based ads

may involve advertising partners using cookies or identifiers, and you will be able to opt out as described above.

11. International Data Transfers

We are based in the United States and process data there and in other countries where our providers operate. If you are in the EEA, UK, or Switzerland, we transfer data outside your region using lawful mechanisms such as Standard Contractual Clauses, the UK Addendum, or an applicable adequacy decision, including the EU-U.S. Data Privacy Framework where a recipient is certified. You may request a copy of the safeguards by contacting us.

12. Security

We use reasonable administrative, technical, and organizational safeguards, including encryption in transit, access controls, hashed credentials where applicable, and monitoring. No system is completely secure, and we cannot guarantee the security of your information. You are responsible for protecting your credentials. If a breach affects you, we will notify you and regulators as required by law.

13. Children

The Service is for adults only and is not directed to anyone under 18. We do not knowingly collect personal information from anyone under 18. If you believe a child has given us personal information, contact support@devs-connect.com, and we will delete it.

14. Third-Party Links and Services

The Service links to and integrates with third-party sites and services (including GitHub). Their privacy practices are governed by their own policies, and we are not responsible for them. You can review and revoke GitHub access in your GitHub settings.

15. Changes to This Policy

We may update this Policy from time to time. For material changes, we will provide notice by email, in-app notice, or a prominent posting, and update the effective date above, before the change takes effect where required by law. Continued use after the effective date means you accept the updated Policy, except where the law requires your consent, in which case we will obtain it.

16. Controller and Contact

The data controller is Samuel Weimer, doing business as DevsConnect, 2272 Lupine Lane, Christiansburg, VA 24073, US. Privacy inquiries and requests: support@devs-connect.com. EU/UK representative (if required): not currently appointed.

PART 3: ACCEPTABLE USE & PROJECT COLLABORATION GUIDELINES

Effective Date: October 24, 2026

devs-connect exists to help developers build careers, share knowledge, and find people to build with. These Guidelines are part of our Terms of Service. Violating them may result in content removal, restrictions, suspension, or termination at our sole discretion, and we may report unlawful conduct to authorities. Community moderators may enforce additional rules that are consistent with these Guidelines.

1. Be Respectful and Safe

You may not post or send content or engage in conduct that:

- Harasses, bullies, threatens, stalks, or intimidates any person, or encourages violence or self-harm.
- Promotes hatred or discrimination against people based on race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, disability, age, or other protected characteristics.
- Is sexually explicit, exploitative, or involves minors in any sexual or harmful way. We have zero tolerance for child sexual exploitation and will report it to the appropriate authorities.
- Doxxes, or shares another person's private information (including contact details, financial data, or private messages) without permission.
- Is graphically violent, or depicts or promotes illegal activity.

2. Be Honest and Authentic

- Do not impersonate any person, company, or organization, or falsely claim affiliation with any person, company, or open-source project (including LinkedIn, GitHub, Reddit, or Microsoft).
- Do not falsify credentials, employment history, certifications, repositories, contributions, or skills, or fake GitHub activity.
- Do not create fake, duplicate, or automated accounts, buy or sell accounts, or manipulate votes, likes, followers, or rankings.
- Do not post deceptive, fraudulent, or misleading listings, including scams, fake job or equity offers, pyramid or multi-level marketing schemes, or schemes to collect fees from developers.
- Do not spread spam, unsolicited bulk messages, or excessive self-promotion. Recruiting is allowed only through designated features and in accordance with our rules.

3. Respect Intellectual Property and Confidentiality

- Post only code and content you have the right to share. Identify third-party code and respect its license (MIT, Apache 2.0, BSD, GPL, AGPL, and others).
- Do not post content that infringes copyright, trademark, patent, or trade-secret rights, or that violates an employer, client, or contractual confidentiality obligation.
- Do not post leaked, stolen, or proprietary source code, credentials, or confidential business information that you are not authorized to disclose.
- Respect the intellectual property of other users. Do not copy another user's project ideas, listings, or code in violation of their rights or license terms.
- Rights holders can report infringement under Section 12 of the Terms (DMCA).

4. Keep the Platform Secure

You may not:

- Upload, link to, or distribute malware, ransomware, spyware, backdoors, or other malicious code, or code designed to damage, disrupt, or gain unauthorized access to systems, accounts, or data. (Security research and educational discussion are welcome when conducted lawfully, responsibly, and without sharing live exploits against specific targets or victims' data.)
- Probe, scan, or test the vulnerability of the Service without our written authorization, or circumvent authentication, rate limits, or access controls.
- Scrape, crawl, harvest, or bulk-collect data (including profiles, emails, or messages) by automated or manual means, or use the Service to build lead lists or datasets, without our written permission.
- Overload or interfere with the Service, its infrastructure, or other users' enjoyment.
- Share your credentials, or use someone else's account without permission.

If you find a security vulnerability, please report it privately to support@devs-connect.com before disclosing it publicly, and give us a reasonable chance to fix it.

5. Project, LFG, and Co-Founder Listings

Because devs-connect is a passive matchmaking venue and does not vet users or projects (see Section 7 of the Terms), the following rules apply to anyone who posts or responds to project, team, or co-founder listings:

- **Be accurate.** Describe the project, roles, time commitment, and compensation (paid, unpaid, equity, revenue share, or volunteer) truthfully and clearly. Do not misrepresent the stage, funding, traction, or ownership of a project.
- **Be transparent about money and equity.** State up front whether work is paid or unpaid. Do not solicit free labor under the guise of a paid or career-making opportunity, and do not promise equity, employment, or compensation you do not intend or have no authority to give.
- **Do not charge developers to join** a project, team, or community, and do not request payment, sensitive personal data, or access to personal accounts or devices as a condition of participating.
- **Put it in writing.** Before contributing meaningful work or sharing sensitive materials, agree in a written document on IP ownership or assignment, licensing, equity or compensation, roles, confidentiality, and what happens if someone leaves or the project ends. We recommend a qualified attorney review any co-founder or equity agreement. devs-connect does not provide templates as legal advice and is not a party to your agreement.
- **Respect existing obligations.** Do not recruit for or work on a project in a way that breaches your or another person's employer IP assignment, non-compete, non-solicitation, or confidentiality obligations. Do not bring in your employer's or client's code, data, or trade secrets.
- **Protect each other.** Do not share a collaborator's confidential information or code outside the project without permission. Act in good faith, communicate if you can no longer contribute, and hand off work responsibly.
- **Do not post restricted work.** No listings for illegal activity, malware, harassment tools, account or credential trading, academic dishonesty services, or projects that infringe others' rights.

- **Be careful with unvetted contacts.** Verify identities independently, avoid sharing sensitive data early, be cautious about sending money or deploying unknown code on your machines, and use caution when meeting in person.

6. Code and Technical Content

- Code you share is your responsibility. Where possible, include license information and note known risks or limitations.
- Do not share code intended to harm, deceive, or exploit others.
- Do not run or recommend that others run untrusted code without appropriate warnings.
- Disclose AI-generated or AI-assisted content where it is material or where a community requires it, and do not post AI-generated content that you cannot stand behind or that violates these Guidelines.

7. Messaging and Communities

- Do not send unsolicited commercial messages or repeated unwanted contact. Respect blocks and “no” answers.
- Use communities for their intended topics and follow their rules. Moderators may remove content and members from their communities.
- Do not bypass blocks or visibility settings using alternate accounts or other means.

8. Reporting and Enforcement

Reporting. Use the in-app report and feedback tools or email support@devs-connect.com to report content or conduct that you believe violates these Guidelines. Blocking another user is available at any time.

Enforcement. We may, in our sole discretion and with or without notice, remove or restrict content, limit features, issue warnings, suspend or terminate accounts, preserve and disclose information to law enforcement, and take legal action. We are not obligated to monitor, and our decision not to act on a report is not a waiver or an endorsement. Enforcement decisions are discretionary and, subject to applicable law, final. If you believe we made a mistake, you may contact support@devs-connect.com; we may, but are not required to, review the decision.

Repeat violations. Repeat or severe violations (including threats, child safety violations, malware, fraud, or repeat copyright infringement) may result in permanent termination.

9. Changes

We may update these Guidelines at any time with the notice described in the Terms. Questions: support@devs-connect.com.

By signing up, users agree they are at least 18 and agree to the Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, and Acceptable Use & Project Collaboration Guidelines.